

VOLUME 12

Colorwork Knitting

250 patterns featuring Fair Isle, intarsia, stranded, mosaic, and geometric colorwork techniques

The Ultimate Knitting Library

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Fair Isle Sweaters

Classic stranded colorwork sweaters inspired by Shetland tradition, featuring allover patterning with no more than two colors per row and circular construction for seamless beauty.

Shetland Mist Pullover

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1400yd · Colors: 6

A traditional Shetland allover pullover with peerie patterns between main motif bands. Worked in the round with steeks for armholes and front neck shaping.

Harbour Light Yoke Sweater

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1350yd · Colors: 5

A circular yoke sweater featuring a bold starburst motif radiating from the neckline, with graduated bands of smaller OXO patterns below the yoke.

Moorland Heather Cardigan

Advanced

Yarn: Fingering weight · Needles: 3.25mm · Yardage: 1800yd · Colors: 8

A steeked cardigan with allover Fair Isle patterning inspired by heather-covered moorlands. Features seven distinct motif bands and corrugated ribbing at cuffs and hem.

North Sea Gale Pullover

Advanced

Yarn: Fingering weight · Needles: 3mm · Yardage: 1900yd · Colors: 7

Dense allover stranded knitting with wave-inspired motifs and small anchor peerie bands. Circular construction with steeks for a traditional Shetland finish.

Pebble Shore Vest

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 800yd · Colors: 5

A fitted Fair Isle vest with seed-like peerie motifs mimicking a pebble beach. Steeked armholes and V-neck with picked-up corrugated rib edging.

Twilight Croft Pullover

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1400yd · Colors: 6

An evening-inspired colorway with deep blues and purples arranged in classic XO and diamond motifs. Worked bottom-up in the round with drop-shoulder construction.

Wildflower Meadow Yoke

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1300yd · Colors: 7

A cheerful yoke sweater with stylized flower and leaf motifs in the round yoke, transitioning to a simple stripe body. Great introduction to multi-color yoke shaping.

Creel & Catch Gansey

Advanced

Yarn: Fingering weight · Needles: 3mm · Yardage: 1750yd · Colors: 5

Combines Fair Isle stranded colorwork with traditional gansey texture in alternating bands. Features a fish and net motif across the chest with peerie borders.

Broch Tower Tunic

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1500yd · Colors: 5

A longer-length tunic with stacked motifs resembling stone tower walls. Simple two-color-per-row construction makes this accessible despite its dramatic appearance.

Herring Bone Fair Isle

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1350yd · Colors: 6

Diagonal chevron motifs evoke a herringbone effect across the entire sweater body. Attention to color dominance ensures crisp pattern definition throughout.

Solstice Ring Pullover

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1400yd · Colors: 5

Concentric ring motifs in the yoke radiate outward, inspired by standing stone circles. The body features a subtle allover dot pattern for texture contrast.

Lambing Season Cardigan

Advanced

Yarn: Fingering weight · Needles: 3.25mm · Yardage: 1850yd · Colors: 7

A steeked cardigan with charming sheep and fence motifs between classic Fair Isle bands. Corrugated ribbing in contrasting colors frames the button bands.

Tide Pool Raglan

Beginner

Yarn: Worsted weight · Needles: 5mm ·
Yardage: 1100yd · Colors: 4

An approachable top-down raglan with simple stranded bands at the yoke and cuffs. Uses only two colors per row with short repeats, ideal for Fair Isle beginners.

Cliffside Winds Pullover

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1400yd · Colors: 6

Windswept diagonal motifs alternate with small seed patterns, creating a sense of movement. Worked in the round with traditional Shetland finishing techniques.

Oat & Barley Waistcoat

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 750yd · Colors: 5

A warm-toned Fair Isle vest inspired by harvest grain fields. Features ear-of-wheat motifs in the main bands with tiny cross peeries as fillers.

Aurora Borealis Yoke

Advanced

Yarn: Fingering weight · Needles: 3.25mm · Yardage: 1700yd · Colors: 9

A show-stopping yoke sweater with graduated color shifts mimicking the northern lights. Requires careful attention to color dominance for the flowing effect.

Crofter's Garden Cardigan

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1500yd · Colors: 6

A steeked cardigan with stylized garden flowers and fence-post borders. The button band is finished with a facing that conceals the steek edge cleanly.

Stone Fence Pullover

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1350yd · Colors: 5

Horizontal zigzag bands resemble dry-stone walls layered across the sweater. A study in simple geometric repeats that build into a complex visual texture.

Puffin Colony Sweater

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1400yd · Colors: 6

Charming puffin silhouettes march across the yoke between seacliff-inspired border patterns. The body is worked in a simple two-color check below the yoke.

Driftwood Bay Henley

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1300yd · Colors: 5

A henley-neck Fair Isle with muted earth tones and wave-and-wood motifs. The placket is steeked and reinforced with crochet before cutting.

Peerie Star Turtleneck

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1450yd · Colors: 5

Allover tiny star motifs in a classic peerie arrangement with a folded turtleneck in corrugated ribbing. Consistent float management keeps the fabric supple.

Midwinter Flame Pullover

Advanced

Yarn: Fingering weight · Needles: 3mm · Yardage: 1800yd · Colors: 7

Flame-shaped motifs rise from the hem in warm reds and oranges against a deep navy ground. Features long floats that must be caught every third stitch.

Sea Glass Collection Vest

Beginner

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 700yd · Colors: 4

Soft aqua and green tones in simple dash-and-dot motifs. An excellent first Fair Isle project with short pattern repeats and only two colors per row.

Kettle Dyeing Yoke Pullover

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1350yd · Colors: 6

Designed to showcase semi-solid and tonal yarns in the Fair Isle tradition. Motif bands are scaled to let hand-dyed color variations enhance the pattern.

Solan Goose Sweater

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1400yd · Colors: 5

Gannet-inspired motifs soar across the chest band with ocean-wave peeries below. Worked seamlessly in the round with a traditional underarm gusset.

Bressay Lighthouse Cardigan

Advanced

Yarn: Fingering weight · Needles: 3.25mm · Yardage: 1900yd · Colors: 8

An ambitious steeked cardigan with lighthouse and wave motifs in the yoke. Features allover patterns with fourteen distinct chart rows and sewn steek reinforcement.

Rowan Berry Pullover

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1350yd · Colors: 5

Red berry clusters and leafy branches form the main motif bands, separated by classic cross-and-diamond peeries in autumnal tones.

Fisherman's Compass Sweater

Advanced

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1500yd · Colors: 6

A compass rose motif dominates the chest panel, surrounded by wave and rope border patterns. Requires careful chart reading for the large central motif.

Lichen Rock Tunic

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1550yd · Colors: 5

Organic, asymmetrical lichen-like motifs in muted greens and grays. Longer tunic length with side vents and an allover pattern that reads as texture from a distance.

Selkie Song Raglan

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1300yd · Colors: 5

Top-down raglan with seal-inspired motifs in the yoke and undulating wave borders. The raglan increases are incorporated into the colorwork charting.

Hebridean Hawk Pullover

Advanced

Yarn: Fingering weight · Needles: 3mm ·
Yardage: 1750yd · Colors: 6

Stylized hawk motifs in flight across the chest with mountain silhouette peeries. Dense stranded fabric at a fine gauge produces a windproof garment.

Neap Tide Crewneck

Beginner

Yarn: Worsted weight · Needles: 5mm ·
Yardage: 1050yd · Colors: 3

A gentle introduction to Fair Isle with only three colors and wide, forgiving motif bands. Larger gauge means fewer stitches per round and faster progress.

Lerwick Lanes Pullover

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage:
1400yd · Colors: 6

Inspired by the winding streets of Lerwick, this sweater features angular pathway motifs interlocking across the body in six coordinating colors.

Peat Smoke Henley

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage:
1350yd · Colors: 5

Smoky browns and charcoals in a swirling motif suggesting rising peat smoke. The henley placket is finished with an i-cord bind-off for a neat edge.

Starling Murmuration Yoke

Advanced

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage:
1450yd · Colors: 7

Bird silhouettes sweep across the circular yoke in a murmuration formation. Requires reading a large yoke chart and managing seven colors across the pattern.

Croft House Cardigan

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage:
1500yd · Colors: 6

A cozy steeked cardigan with house and chimney motifs alternating with diamond bands. Pewter buttons complement the traditional Shetland color palette.

Kelp Forest Pullover

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1400yd · Colors: 5

Sinuuous kelp frond motifs weave through the body in oceanic greens and teals. The organic curves are achieved through careful chart design within the two-color limit.

Standing Stones Vest

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 800yd · Colors: 5

Tall rectangular motifs evoke ancient standing stones against a twilight sky. A dramatic vest with deep armholes and a generous V-neck.

Otter's Holt Pullover

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1350yd · Colors: 5

Playful otter silhouettes swim through wave-pattern bands in rich browns and blues. A fun novelty Fair Isle that still respects the two-color-per-row tradition.

Frost Crystal Yoke

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1300yd · Colors: 5

Delicate ice-crystal motifs in white and pale blue radiate across the yoke. The body transitions to a subtle allover seed pattern in two neutral tones.

Burnt Umber Fair Isle

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1400yd · Colors: 6

Warm earth-tone palette with terracotta, sienna, and cream in traditional OXO and diamond arrangements. A masterclass in how palette selection transforms classic motifs.

Nesting Plover Pullover

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1350yd · Colors: 5

Small bird-and-egg motifs nestle between zigzag border patterns. Worked in soft moors-inspired tones with careful attention to selvedge stitches at steek edges.

Gale Warning Turtleneck

Advanced

Yarn: Fingering weight · Needles: 3.25mm · Yardage: 1800yd · Colors: 6

Dense allover pattern with stylized weather vane and wind motifs. The folded turtleneck features its own miniature Fair Isle pattern for a polished look.

Thistle Crown Sweater

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1400yd · Colors: 6

Scottish thistle motifs crown the yoke with spiky leaves and rounded flower heads. The thorny beauty translates surprisingly well into simple two-color charting.

Cinnamon Spice Cardigan

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1500yd · Colors: 5

Warm spice-toned palette in classic eight-pointed star and cross motifs. Steeked front opening with crocheted reinforcement and a neat knitted button band.

Viking Ship Yoke

Advanced

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1450yd · Colors: 7

Stylized longship silhouettes sail around the circular yoke above ocean wave borders. A statement piece requiring precise chart following for the pictorial motifs.

Blackberry Bramble Pullover

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1350yd · Colors: 5

Berry clusters and thorny vine motifs in deep purples and greens with cream highlights. Peerie bands of tiny leaves separate the main pattern repeats.

Archipelago Crewneck

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1400yd · Colors: 6

Island chain motifs scattered across the body suggest an aerial view of the Shetland archipelago. A creative modern interpretation of Fair Isle tradition.

Hearthside Glow Pullover

Beginner

Yarn: Worsted weight · Needles: 5mm ·

Yardage: 1100yd · Colors: 4

Simple flame-inspired motifs in warm oranges and reds on a charcoal ground. Wide repeats and chunky gauge make this an accessible introduction to stranded colorwork.

Stranded Colorwork

Stranded knitting techniques beyond traditional Fair Isle, including multi-color designs, float management, and techniques for maintaining even tension across complex charts.

Persian Garden Cowl

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 450yd · Colors: 6

A deep cowl featuring Persian tile-inspired motifs with intricate floral centers. Worked in the round with floats caught every fourth stitch to prevent snagging.

Kaleidoscope Pullover

Advanced

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1500yd · Colors: 8

Rotating geometric motifs create a kaleidoscope effect across the body. Uses up to three colors per row in select sections, requiring careful float management.

Constellation Map Sweater

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1400yd · Colors: 4

Star constellations are charted across a deep navy ground with connecting lines in silver-gray. Duplicate stitch adds the smallest stars after knitting for precision.

Lattice Window Cardigan

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1500yd · Colors: 5

Diamond lattice framework with contrasting fills creates a stained-glass window effect. Steeked opening with a knitted-on button band and facings.

Marble Swirl Hat

Beginner

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 150yd · Colors: 3

Spiraling two-color bands create a marbled effect on this simple stranded hat. Perfect for practicing even tension before tackling larger stranded projects.

Autumn Canopy Pullover

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1400yd · Colors: 6

Overlapping leaf silhouettes in graduated fall colors from green through gold to rust. Careful color dominance ensures the foreground leaves pop against the background.

Compass Rose Tam

Intermediate

Yarn: Fingering weight · Needles: 3.25mm · Yardage: 200yd · Colors: 5

A traditional tam with a bold compass rose radiating from the crown. The circular format perfectly showcases the radial symmetry of the design.

Fjord Reflections Vest

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 850yd · Colors: 5

Mountain and water reflection motifs mirrored at the waistline create a serene landscape across the torso. Stranded colorwork with floats caught behind the longer spans.

Honeycomb Hive Pullover

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1350yd · Colors: 4

Tessellating hexagons in golden honey tones with tiny bee motifs scattered throughout. The geometric structure makes for an extremely satisfying knit with clean floats.

Thunderbird Blanket Coat

Advanced

Yarn: Worsted weight · Needles: 5mm · Yardage: 2200yd · Colors: 6

An oversized blanket coat with bold thunderbird-inspired geometric motifs. The heavier gauge produces a warm, structured fabric with excellent stitch definition.

Cherry Blossom Float

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1300yd · Colors: 5

Scattered cherry blossom branches on a pale ground with petals drifting downward. Long floats are caught behind the background to maintain even tension.

Pixel Art Crewneck

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1400yd · Colors: 6

Retro pixel-art motifs (hearts, mushrooms, stars) arranged in a grid pattern. Each motif block uses only two colors, keeping float management simple despite the playful complexity.

Peacock Feather Shawl

Advanced

Yarn: Fingering weight · Needles: 3.25mm · Yardage: 1200yd · Colors: 7

Stranded colorwork peacock eye motifs arranged in a crescent shawl. Short rows shape the crescent while maintaining the charted pattern alignment.

Brick Lane Pullover

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1350yd · Colors: 4

Offset brick-pattern colorwork in warm terracotta and cream. Simple two-color repeat creates a surprisingly modern architectural effect with minimal float management.

Northern Lights Beanie

Beginner

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 130yd · Colors: 4

Graduated color bands suggest the aurora in a simple stranded beanie. Ideal for learning to manage tension when changing between background and pattern colors.

Sampler Band Pullover

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1400yd · Colors: 6

Seven different stranded motif bands stacked vertically, each showcasing a different colorwork tradition. A knitter's sampler that teaches multiple pattern-reading skills.

Art Deco Chevron Sweater

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1350yd · Colors: 5

Bold chevron bands in an Art Deco palette of black, gold, cream, and teal. The strong geometric lines require consistent tension to keep the chevron points sharp.

Scattered Seeds Mittens

Beginner

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 3.75mm · Yardage: 120yd · Colors: 3

Tiny seed-like dots scattered across a contrasting ground in these simple stranded mittens. An ideal project for building confidence with two-handed stranded technique.

Totem Pole Vest

Advanced

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 900yd · Colors: 7

Bold figurative motifs stacked in vertical panels down the front. Three colors per row in the main panels demand careful strand management and consistent gauge.

Pinwheel Party Hat

Beginner

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 140yd · Colors: 4

Spinning pinwheel motifs in bright primary colors on a white ground. The crown decreases spiral through the colorwork for a dynamic finish at the top.

Woodland Floor Pullover

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1400yd · Colors: 6

Mushroom, fern, and acorn motifs scattered across a forest-floor landscape. Duplicate stitch adds small detail accents after the main stranded knitting is complete.

Stormfront Pullover

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1400yd · Colors: 5

Dramatic cloud and lightning bolt motifs in charcoal, slate, and electric yellow. The contrast between dark and bright colors creates striking stitch definition.

River Delta Wrap

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 900yd · Colors: 5

Branching river motifs flow across a rectangular wrap in blues and greens. Flat stranded knitting with a purl-side facing requires reading charts from both directions.

Cathedral Rose Pullover

Advanced

Yarn: Fingering weight · Needles: 3.25mm · Yardage: 1800yd · Colors: 8

Rose window motifs inspired by gothic cathedral architecture. The circular medallions are charted within a two-color-per-row constraint using strategic color placement.

Tundra Frost Mittens

Intermediate

Yarn: Fingering weight · Needles: 3mm · Yardage: 180yd · Colors: 4

Ice crystal and snowflake motifs on dense fingering-weight mittens. The tight gauge produces a windproof fabric with crisp pattern definition throughout.

Mondrian Block Sweater

Advanced

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1450yd · Colors: 5

Abstract color blocks inspired by Mondrian compositions. Combines stranded sections with intarsia-in-the-round technique for the larger color areas.

Snowdrift Yoke Pullover

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1300yd · Colors: 4

Drifting snow crystal motifs in whites and pale blues cascade down the yoke. Minimal color palette with maximum textural interest from the stranded fabric.

Dragon Scale Gauntlets

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 3.75mm · Yardage: 200yd · Colors: 4

Overlapping scale motifs in metallic-toned yarns create an armor-like effect. The long fingerless format showcases the repeating scale pattern beautifully.

Origami Crane Pullover

Advanced

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1400yd · Colors: 5

Stylized paper crane silhouettes in flight across the chest in a Japanese-inspired palette. The angular crane shapes translate perfectly into knitted colorwork charting.

Sedimentary Layers Cowl

Beginner

Yarn: Worsted weight · Needles: 5mm · Yardage: 350yd · Colors: 5

Horizontal stripes with stranded pattern bands mimicking geological sediment layers. Color changes happen at natural break points, keeping float management minimal.

Carousel Ponies Pullover

Advanced

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1500yd · Colors: 7

Prancing carousel horse motifs circle the yoke in a whimsical stranded design. Large pictorial motifs require careful chart reading and float catching.

Moroccan Tile Vest

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 800yd · Colors: 5

Interlocking zellige-inspired tile motifs in Mediterranean blues and whites. The tessellating pattern creates an allover design with no obvious beginning or end.

Magnetic Field Lines Sweater

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1400yd · Colors: 4

Curved lines radiating from central points mimic magnetic field patterns. The organic curves are approximated through carefully stepped stitch placement in the chart.

Marigold Chain Pullover

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1350yd · Colors: 5

Linked marigold flower motifs form continuous chains across the body. The round flower shapes with pointed petals create a lively, garden-inspired fabric.

Fossil Record Cardigan

Advanced

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1550yd · Colors: 6

Ammonite spirals and fern fossil motifs in stone-inspired earth tones. Steeked cardigan with front facings that conceal the cut edges completely.

Circuit Board Beanie

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 130yd · Colors: 3

Angular circuit-trace motifs in neon green on a black ground. The right-angle pathways translate naturally into the grid of knitted stitches.

Wildfire Gradient Pullover

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1400yd · Colors: 6

Flame motifs intensify from smoldering embers at the hem to full blaze at the chest. Gradient color shifts within the stranded pattern create a dynamic ombre effect.

Snowshoe Hare Mittens

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 3.75mm · Yardage: 140yd · Colors: 3

Camouflaged hare silhouettes blend into a snowy forest background. The subtle color play between white, cream, and pale gray rewards close inspection.

Tide Chart Pullover

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1350yd · Colors: 4

Wave-height curves translated into a stranded colorwork chart create an abstract tide pattern. The rhythmic rise and fall of the motif mirrors actual tidal data.

Intarsia

Large-block color knitting worked flat, using separate bobbins for each color area and twisting yarns at color boundaries to prevent holes — ideal for pictorial and bold graphic designs.

Sunset Canyon Throw

Intermediate

Yarn: Worsted weight · Needles: 5mm ·
Yardage: 2000yd · Colors: 7

A landscape throw with canyon layers in graduated sunset colors. Each horizontal band uses separate bobbins, with yarn twists at the undulating boundary lines.

Abstract Brushstroke Pullover

Advanced

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage:
1400yd · Colors: 6

Bold diagonal color blocks mimic abstract brushstrokes across the sweater front. Multiple bobbins hang simultaneously, requiring careful organization to avoid tangles.

Mountain Silhouette Pillow

Beginner

Yarn: Worsted weight · Needles: 5mm ·
Yardage: 350yd · Colors: 4

A simple mountain range silhouette against a sunset sky on a square pillow cover. An excellent first intarsia project with gentle diagonal lines and few bobbins.

Bauhaus Color Block Cardigan

Advanced

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage:
1600yd · Colors: 6

Large geometric color blocks in primary colors with black outlines. Each block requires its own bobbin; the outlined style means frequent color changes at boundaries.

Tropical Parrot Panel

Advanced

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage:
600yd · Colors: 10

A pictorial wall hanging featuring a macaw parrot on a tropical branch. Complex intarsia with up to eight bobbins active per row for detailed feather coloring.

Coastline Contour Scarf

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage:
500yd · Colors: 4

An undulating coastline divides sea from land colors down the length of a wide scarf. Reversible finishing technique hides the intarsia twists on both sides.

Poppy Field Pullover

Advanced

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1500yd · Colors: 6

Large red poppies scattered across a green field on the sweater front. Each poppy is a separate intarsia section; stems are added in duplicate stitch afterward.

Color Wheel Cushion

Intermediate

Yarn: Worsted weight · Needles: 5mm · Yardage: 400yd · Colors: 7

A round cushion cover with pie-wedge color segments forming a complete color wheel. Short-row wedges combined with intarsia color changes create the circular design.

City Skyline Pullover

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1400yd · Colors: 5

A stylized city skyline silhouette across the chest in black against graduated sky colors. The angular building shapes are straightforward to chart and knit.

Argyle Classic Vest

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 800yd · Colors: 4

Traditional argyle diamonds in a gentleman's vest. Diagonal lines are added in duplicate stitch after knitting the intarsia diamond blocks.

Stained Glass Rose Window

Advanced

Yarn: Fingering weight · Needles: 3.25mm · Yardage: 800yd · Colors: 9

A circular wall hanging depicting a rose window with leaded outlines in dark gray. Each "glass" section is a separate color area requiring meticulous bobbin management.

Harlequin Diamond Sweater

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1350yd · Colors: 5

Large harlequin diamond pattern in alternating bold colors across the entire sweater. Regular diagonal joins create a satisfying rhythm once the pattern is established.

Koi Pond Panel

Advanced

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 700yd · Colors: 8

Realistic koi fish swimming through a dark pond with lily pads. Each fish is an independent intarsia island requiring its own set of bobbins.

Split Spectrum Pullover

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1400yd · Colors: 7

A central vertical split divides the sweater into warm and cool color halves. The twist at the center boundary runs the full length, creating a clean division line.

Desert Butte Blanket

Intermediate

Yarn: Worsted weight · Needles: 5mm · Yardage: 2500yd · Colors: 6

Layered desert landscape with mesa and butte silhouettes in warm earth tones. Horizontal intarsia bands with shaped skyline boundaries for a scenic blanket.

Matisse Cutout Cardigan

Advanced

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1500yd · Colors: 5

Organic leaf-like cutout shapes inspired by Matisse paper cuts in bold blue, red, and yellow on white. Free-form intarsia shapes challenge conventional rectangular charting.

Lighthouse at Dusk Pillow

Intermediate

Yarn: Worsted weight · Needles: 5mm · Yardage: 400yd · Colors: 5

A pictorial pillow cover with a lighthouse silhouette against a graduated dusk sky. The simple shapes make this a confidence-building pictorial intarsia project.

Camouflage Field Pullover

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1400yd · Colors: 4

Organic irregular camouflage patches in woodland greens, browns, and tan. The random-looking shapes are carefully charted to minimize the number of active bobbins per row.

Geode Cross-Section Panel

Advanced

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 650yd · Colors: 8

Concentric geode rings in purples, pinks, and crystal white on a rock-gray border. Each ring is a separate intarsia zone with careful joins between the curved boundaries.

Flag Semaphore Scarf

Beginner

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 450yd · Colors: 3

Simple flag motifs in two colors on a neutral ground spell out a message. Rectangular blocks with minimal diagonal lines make this forgiving for intarsia beginners.

Aurora Sky Throw

Intermediate

Yarn: Worsted weight · Needles: 5mm · Yardage: 2200yd · Colors: 7

Sweeping curtains of aurora color undulate across a large throw blanket. The flowing shapes use long diagonal intarsia joins with yarn twists at each color change.

Terrazzo Slab Pullover

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1400yd · Colors: 6

Random chip-like shapes on a neutral ground mimic polished terrazzo flooring. Each "chip" is a small intarsia island; duplicate stitch adds the tiniest fragments.

Watercolor Wash Cardigan

Advanced

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1500yd · Colors: 8

Soft-edged color washes blend into each other as if painted with watercolors. The blended edges use a checkerboard transition zone between solid intarsia areas.

Orca Migration Panel

Advanced

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 700yd · Colors: 4

Three orca whales swimming in formation on a deep ocean background. The high-contrast black and white shapes create dramatic impact with clean intarsia joins.

Map Projection Sweater

Advanced

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1500yd · Colors: 5

A flattened world map across the sweater front and back, with continents in earth tones on ocean blue. Complex coastline shapes require many bobbins and careful chart reading.

Pixel Heart Cushion

Beginner

Yarn: Worsted weight · Needles: 5mm · Yardage: 300yd · Colors: 3

A large pixelated heart centered on a square cushion cover. The blocky shape requires only three bobbins at most per row, making it ideal for learning intarsia joins.

Autumn Tree Silhouette Wrap

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1000yd · Colors: 5

A bare tree silhouette with scattered falling leaves across a wide rectangular wrap. The branches radiate organically, with leaves added in duplicate stitch for precision.

Cubist Portrait Pullover

Advanced

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1500yd · Colors: 7

An abstract cubist-style face composed of geometric color planes on the sweater front. Each angular shape is a separate intarsia section requiring precise chart following.

River Birch Blanket

Intermediate

Yarn: Worsted weight · Needles: 5mm · Yardage: 2400yd · Colors: 5

Vertical birch tree trunks with peeling bark texture against a forest background. The tree shapes run the full length of the blanket as continuous intarsia columns.

Neon Sign Pullover

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1350yd · Colors: 4

A glowing neon script word on a dark ground, with a halo effect in a lighter shade around the letters. The tube-like letter shapes are worked in intarsia with duplicate stitch details.

Japanese Wave Panel

Advanced

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 650yd · Colors: 5

Hokusai-inspired wave motif with curling whitecaps in a square wall panel. The flowing curves are approximated through diagonal stitch stepping in the intarsia chart.

Color Field Blanket

Beginner

Yarn: Worsted weight · Needles: 5mm · Yardage: 2000yd · Colors: 6

Large rectangular color blocks arranged in an asymmetric grid like a Rothko painting. Straight boundaries and simple shapes make this a meditative intarsia project.

Tribal Mask Panel

Advanced

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 600yd · Colors: 6

A bold stylized mask face in earth tones and black for a dramatic wall hanging. Symmetrical design means each half mirrors the other, simplifying the chart reading.

Topographic Contour Pullover

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1400yd · Colors: 5

Flowing topographic contour lines in graduated colors across the sweater body. The organic, undulating boundaries create a modern landscape effect in intarsia.

Sunflower Burst Pillow

Intermediate

Yarn: Worsted weight · Needles: 5mm · Yardage: 400yd · Colors: 5

A single large sunflower face fills the pillow front with radiating petals in golden yellows. The circular shape is achieved through intarsia with careful boundary management.

Mosaic Knitting

Slip-stitch colorwork that produces stunning multi-color patterns while knitting with only one color per row — no floats, no bobbins, no tangles. Deceptively complex-looking results from a simple technique.

Zigzag Maze Blanket

Beginner

Yarn: Worsted weight · Needles: 5mm ·
Yardage: 1800yd · Colors: 2

Bold zigzag pathways created entirely through slip-stitch colorwork. Only one color is worked per row, with slipped stitches creating the two-color illusion.

Cathedral Arches Cowl

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage:
350yd · Colors: 2

Pointed arch motifs repeat around a deep cowl in contrasting colors. The gothic window shapes are surprisingly elegant given the simplicity of the slip-stitch technique.

Diamondback Rattler Scarf

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage:
500yd · Colors: 2

Interlocking diamond shapes mimic a rattlesnake's skin pattern. The reversible mosaic technique means both sides of the scarf display a striking, different pattern.

Greek Key Border Pullover

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage:
1300yd · Colors: 2

Classic Greek key meander patterns frame the yoke, hem, and cuffs. The body is solid with mosaic bands, making this an achievable introduction to mosaic garments.

Tumbling Blocks Afghan

Intermediate

Yarn: Worsted weight · Needles: 5mm ·
Yardage: 2200yd · Colors: 3

Three-dimensional tumbling cube illusion achieved entirely with slip-stitch mosaic in three colors. Each pair of rows uses only one color, cycling through all three.

Celtic Knotwork Scarf

Advanced

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage:
550yd · Colors: 2

Interlacing Celtic knot bands run the full length of a generous scarf. The over-under illusion is created by strategic slipping that produces the woven appearance.

Labyrinth Walker Throw

Intermediate

Yarn: Worsted weight · Needles: 5mm ·
Yardage: 2000yd · Colors: 2

A classical labyrinth path spirals from the center outward across the throw. The continuous pathway works perfectly in mosaic technique with its clean geometric lines.

Broken Herringbone Vest

Beginner

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 700yd · Colors: 2

A broken herringbone pattern in two contrasting colors creates a sophisticated tweedy effect. Simple slip-stitch rows build the angled pattern without any float management.

Navajo Stepped Diamond Pillow

Intermediate

Yarn: Worsted weight · Needles: 5mm ·
Yardage: 350yd · Colors: 2

Stepped diamond motifs inspired by Navajo textile patterns on a square pillow. The angular, stepped shapes are ideally suited to the mosaic slip-stitch grid.

Butterfly Wing Shawl

Advanced

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 900yd · Colors: 3

Butterfly wing scale patterns in a triangular shawl using three-color mosaic. Increases along the spine and edges are integrated seamlessly into the mosaic chart.

Optical Illusion Pullover

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1300yd · Colors: 2

Expanding and contracting concentric shapes create a pulsing optical illusion. High contrast between the two colors maximizes the op-art visual effect.

Arrow Flight Socks

Intermediate

Yarn: Fingering weight · Needles: 2.75mm ·
Yardage: 350yd · Colors: 2

Directional arrow motifs point upward along the leg and foot of these mosaic socks. Working mosaic in the round requires adapting the slip pattern for every-row right-side knitting.

Escher Staircase Blanket

Advanced

Yarn: Worsted weight · Needles: 5mm ·
Yardage: 2400yd · Colors: 2

Impossible staircase motifs tile across the blanket in an Escher-inspired tessellation. The mathematical precision of mosaic knitting is perfect for these geometric puzzles.

Moorish Star Cowl

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 400yd · Colors: 2

Eight-pointed stars interlock in a pattern inspired by Moorish architectural tilework. The star shapes emerge beautifully from the mosaic slip-stitch grid.

Woven Plaid Pullover

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1350yd · Colors: 3

A plaid-like woven effect achieved entirely through mosaic slip stitches. Three colors cycle in pairs to produce the characteristic over-and-under weave appearance.

Trellis Vine Cardigan

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1400yd · Colors: 2

Climbing vine motifs on a garden trellis framework in two-color mosaic. The organic vine shapes contrast pleasingly with the rigid lattice structure.

Fibonacci Spiral Throw

Advanced

Yarn: Worsted weight · Needles: 5mm ·
Yardage: 2000yd · Colors: 2

A Fibonacci spiral built from mosaic squares of increasing size. The mathematical progression creates a naturally beautiful composition in simple slip-stitch technique.

Pueblo Sun Hat Band

Beginner

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 100yd · Colors: 2

A sun motif hat band worked in mosaic colorwork, then sewn to a plain stockinette hat. An excellent small project for learning mosaic chart reading.

Chain Link Fence Pullover

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1300yd · Colors: 2

Interlocking chain-link diamond mesh covers the entire sweater in industrial chic style. The allover pattern knits up quickly once the rhythmic slip sequence is memorized.

Peacock Tail Fan Shawl

Advanced

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1000yd · Colors: 3

Radiating fan shapes mimic peacock tail feathers across a semicircular shawl. Three-color mosaic with careful increase placement maintains the fan pattern through shaping.

Basket Weave Illusion Cowl

Beginner

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 300yd · Colors: 2

A woven basket texture illusion using only knit stitches and slipped stitches. The three-dimensional weave appearance defies the flat nature of the fabric.

Sawtooth Ridge Scarf

Beginner

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 400yd · Colors: 2

Sharp sawtooth zigzags in high contrast for a bold, graphic scarf. Simple two-row repeat makes this a rhythmic, meditative knit once the pattern is established.

Kaleidoscope Mosaic Blanket

Intermediate

Yarn: Worsted weight · Needles: 5mm · Yardage: 2200yd · Colors: 3

Modular square blocks, each with a different mosaic motif, are joined into a sampler blanket. Three colors rotate through the blocks for visual variety.

Islamic Geometry Pullover

Advanced

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1400yd · Colors: 2

Complex interlocking geometric stars from Islamic art tradition adapted for mosaic knitting. The mathematical precision of the original designs translates perfectly to the grid.

Houndstooth Check Vest

Beginner

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 700yd · Colors: 2

Classic houndstooth check pattern in a tailored vest. The small-scale repeat is one of the simplest mosaic patterns, producing a timeless, sophisticated fabric.

Desert Rose Table Runner

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 500yd · Colors: 2

Stylized desert rose motifs bloom along a rectangular table runner with fringed ends. The flat construction is ideal for mosaic worked back and forth in rows.

Lightning Strike Socks

Intermediate

Yarn: Fingering weight · Needles: 2.75mm · Yardage: 380yd · Colors: 2

Jagged lightning bolt motifs zigzag down the sock leg in bold two-color mosaic. The angular shapes knit cleanly in the slip-stitch technique without any float issues.

Shadowbox Frame Afghan

Intermediate

Yarn: Worsted weight · Needles: 5mm · Yardage: 2000yd · Colors: 2

Nested rectangular frames create a three-dimensional shadowbox illusion. The stepped edges of each frame produce the depth effect through strategic color placement.

Windmill Blade Tam

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 180yd · Colors: 2

Spinning windmill blade motifs radiate from the crown of a slouchy tam. The circular format showcases the rotational symmetry of the mosaic pattern.

Cross-Hatch Texture Pullover

Beginner

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1250yd · Colors: 2

A simple cross-hatch pattern covers the entire sweater in a subtle woven texture. The small repeat makes this an ideal first mosaic garment with a professional result.

Moroccan Lantern Cowl

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 350yd · Colors: 2

Elongated lantern-shaped motifs inspired by Moroccan metalwork in a cozy cowl. The tall, narrow shapes work beautifully in mosaic with their stepped outlines.

Penrose Triangle Throw

Advanced

Yarn: Worsted weight · Needles: 5mm · Yardage: 2000yd · Colors: 2

Repeating impossible Penrose triangle motifs tile across the throw. The optical illusion of three-dimensionality from flat slip-stitch knitting is wonderfully paradoxical.

Mosaic Bloom Garden Cardigan

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1450yd · Colors: 3

Stylized flower motifs in three-color mosaic cover a relaxed-fit cardigan. The blooms are charted in geometric forms that suit the angular nature of slip-stitch work.

Zigzag Chevron Baby Blanket

Beginner

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 800yd · Colors: 2

Bold chevron stripes in cheerful contrast colors for a baby blanket. The simple zigzag is the most forgiving mosaic pattern, perfect for a first colorwork blanket.

Aztec Pyramid Pullover

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1350yd · Colors: 2

Stepped pyramid motifs with decorative borders inspired by Mesoamerican architecture. The architectural precision of pyramids aligns naturally with the mosaic grid.

Norwegian & Nordic

Patterns rooted in the knitting traditions of Scandinavia — Selbu stars, lusekofte motifs, Icelandic lopapeysa yokes, Latvian braids, and Swedish tvåändsstickning (twined knitting).

Selbu Star Mittens

Intermediate

Yarn: Fingering weight · Needles: 2.75mm ·
Yardage: 200yd · Colors: 2

The classic Selbu eight-pointed star on traditional Norwegian mittens. Black and white colorwork with corrugated ribbing cuffs and a star motif on the thumb.

Lopapeysa Storm Pullover

Intermediate

Yarn: Bulky weight · Needles: 6mm · Yardage: 1000yd · Colors: 4

A classic Icelandic yoke sweater in unspun lopi yarn with a traditional leaf-and-wave pattern. Worked in the round from the bottom up with a circular yoke.

Lusekofte Heritage Sweater

Intermediate

Yarn: Fingering weight · Needles: 3mm ·
Yardage: 1700yd · Colors: 2

A faithful recreation of the Norwegian lice-stitch sweater with scattered single-stitch "lice" across the body and traditional border patterns at yoke and cuffs.

Latvian Braid Wristlets

Intermediate

Yarn: Fingering weight · Needles: 3mm ·
Yardage: 120yd · Colors: 3

Short wristlets featuring the distinctive Latvian braid technique — yarn crossings that create a raised, braided texture between colorwork pattern bands.

Swedish Twined Pullover

Advanced

Yarn: Fingering weight · Needles: 3mm ·
Yardage: 1600yd · Colors: 2

Tvåändsstickning (two-end knitting) creates a dense, warm fabric with crook stitches forming the pattern. The twisting technique produces a distinctive textured colorwork.

Fana Cardigan

Intermediate

Yarn: Fingering weight · Needles: 3.25mm ·
Yardage: 1800yd · Colors: 3

Inspired by the Fana district cardigan with its characteristic checkered pattern bands and pewter clasps. Worked in the round with steeked front opening.

Reindeer Migration Yoke

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1400yd · Colors: 4

Reindeer silhouettes march around the yoke between snowflake border bands in a classic Nordic arrangement. The circular yoke shapes seamlessly through the colorwork.

Setesdal Valley Pullover

Advanced

Yarn: Fingering weight · Needles: 3mm · Yardage: 1800yd · Colors: 2

A traditional black-and-white sweater from the Setesdal region with bold geometric bands and the characteristic horizontal patterning unique to this district.

Icelandic Leaf Yoke Cardigan

Intermediate

Yarn: Bulky weight · Needles: 6mm · Yardage: 1100yd · Colors: 4

A lopapeysa cardigan variation with a leaf motif yoke in natural Icelandic sheep colors. The bulky lopi knits up quickly while maintaining the traditional silhouette.

Marius Pattern Sweater

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1400yd · Colors: 3

Norway's most beloved sweater pattern with its iconic diamond and cross motifs in the national colors. A rite of passage for Nordic knitting enthusiasts.

Finnish Fox Mittens

Intermediate

Yarn: Fingering weight · Needles: 2.75mm · Yardage: 180yd · Colors: 2

Stylized fox motifs on the back of traditional-shaped mittens with a Finnish-style long cuff. Dense stranded fabric in fingering weight for maximum warmth.

Dale of Norway Inspired Vest

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 850yd · Colors: 4

A V-neck vest with allover snowflake and cross motifs in the Dale tradition. Steeked armholes and neckline with picked-up corrugated rib borders.

Latvian Forest Socks

Advanced

Yarn: Fingering weight · Needles: 2.75mm · Yardage: 380yd · Colors: 3

Richly patterned socks with Latvian tree-of-life motifs, Latvian braids at the cuff, and a traditional heel with patterning that continues unbroken.

Viking Knot Pullover

Advanced

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1500yd · Colors: 3

Interlacing Viking knotwork bands encircle the yoke and hem. The over-under braid illusion is achieved through careful color dominance in the stranded knitting.

Snowflake Sampler Blanket

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 2000yd · Colors: 2

Twenty different Nordic snowflake motifs arranged in a grid blanket, each in its own bordered square. A reference sampler of traditional Scandinavian snow crystal designs.

Korsnäs Sweater

Advanced

Yarn: Fingering weight · Needles: 3mm · Yardage: 1700yd · Colors: 5

Inspired by the richly embellished Korsnäs tradition with dense floral and geometric motifs in multiple colors. Features traditional construction with underarm gussets.

Telemark Rose Cardigan

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1500yd · Colors: 4

Rosemaling-inspired rose motifs from Telemark decorate the yoke of a steeked cardigan. The flowing rose shapes are simplified into the stranded colorwork grid.

Polar Night Beanie

Beginner

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 120yd · Colors: 3

Simple Nordic star motifs in a classic color scheme on a ribbed beanie. An accessible entry point to Scandinavian colorwork traditions with forgiving gauge.

Icelandic Sheep Yoke Pullover

Intermediate

Yarn: Bulky weight · Needles: 6mm · Yardage: 1050yd · Colors: 4

Charming sheep silhouettes circle the yoke of this lopapeysa-style sweater in natural undyed Icelandic wool colors. A playful take on the traditional yoke format.

Estonian Nupps Colorwork Gloves

Advanced

Yarn: Fingering weight · Needles: 2.75mm · Yardage: 200yd · Colors: 3

Combines Estonian nupp bobbles with stranded colorwork on fitted gloves. The textured nupps sit atop the colorwork pattern for a richly dimensional surface.

Halland Star Cushion

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 350yd · Colors: 3

A large Swedish eight-pointed star from the Halland region fills a square cushion. Worked in the round, then steeked and backed for a clean pillow cover.

Nordland Pullover

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1400yd · Colors: 3

A Norwegian pullover from the Nordland region with its distinctive horizontal pattern placement and strong geometric borders at chest, waist, and upper arms.

Faroese Shawl with Colorwork

Advanced

Yarn: Fingering weight · Needles: 3.25mm · Yardage: 800yd · Colors: 4

A butterfly-shaped Faroese shawl incorporating stranded colorwork bands between the garter-stitch body. Center-back shaping creates the distinctive Faroese drape.

Greenland Anorak Pullover

Advanced

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1500yd · Colors: 5

Inspired by Greenlandic beadwork patterns translated into stranded knitting. Dense geometric motifs cover the yoke with a deep, richly patterned chest band.

Sami Band Wristlets

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 3.75mm · Yardage: 100yd · Colors: 3

Traditional Sami-inspired band patterns in red, blue, and yellow on short wristlets. The narrow band motifs wrap around the wrist in continuous repeats.

Lillehammer Festival Sweater

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1400yd · Colors: 4

A celebration sweater combining multiple Norwegian motif traditions: Selbu stars, lice stitch, and geometric borders in a harmonious arrangement.

Twined Knitting Socks

Advanced

Yarn: Fingering weight · Needles: 2.75mm · Yardage: 350yd · Colors: 2

Swedish tvåändsstickning socks with the characteristic two-strand twisting technique. Crook stitches create the pattern on a dense, extremely warm fabric.

Norwegian Wedding Blanket

Advanced

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 2800yd · Colors: 3

A ceremonial blanket with paired bird motifs, heart borders, and tree-of-life central panels in the Norwegian bridal tradition. A legacy heirloom project.

Bohus-Inspired Yoke Pullover

Advanced

Yarn: Fingering weight · Needles: 3.25mm · Yardage: 1600yd · Colors: 7

Inspired by the Swedish Bohus Stickning cooperative tradition with angora accents and purl-stitch texture within the stranded yoke. Subtle, sophisticated color blending.

Nordic Ski Band Headband

Beginner

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 80yd · Colors: 2

A wide headband with traditional Norwegian cross and star motifs. Quick to knit and an ideal introduction to Nordic two-color stranded technique.

Åland Islands Pullover

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1350yd · Colors: 4

A Finnish-Swedish hybrid with maritime motifs from the Åland archipelago — anchors, fish, and wave borders in the blue and white island tradition.

Dalarna Horse Sweater

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1400yd · Colors: 5

Swedish Dala horse motifs trot across the yoke between traditional rosemaling-inspired floral borders. Bright folk-art colors on a deep blue ground.

Icefall Mittens

Intermediate

Yarn: Fingering weight · Needles: 2.75mm · Yardage: 190yd · Colors: 3

Cascading icicle motifs drip down the back of insulated winter mittens. The vertical drip pattern works well with the top-to-cuff mitten construction direction.

Hardanger Rose Vest

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 800yd · Colors: 4

Rose motifs from Norway's Hardanger region decorate a fitted vest with corrugated rib borders. The stylized roses pair beautifully with geometric diamond fillers.

Midnight Sun Pullover

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1400yd · Colors: 5

A circular yoke with radiating sun motifs in warm golds against arctic blue. The continuous daylight of Nordic summer captured in stranded colorwork.

Colorwork Accessories

Hats, mittens, cowls, socks, bags, and other accessories showcasing colorwork techniques — perfect for practicing new skills or creating quick, colorful gifts.

Bramble Path Beanie

Beginner

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 120yd · Colors: 3

A slouchy beanie with simple stranded bramble motifs around the brim. Crown decreases are worked in a single color for a clean finish.

Spice Market Mittens

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 3.75mm · Yardage: 160yd · Colors: 5

Rich saffron, paprika, and cinnamon tones in a mosaic-tile inspired colorwork pattern. Long cuffs with corrugated ribbing and a patterned thumb gusset.

Snowfall Infinity Cowl

Beginner

Yarn: Worsted weight · Needles: 5mm · Yardage: 400yd · Colors: 3

Scattered snowflake motifs drift across a cozy double-wrapped infinity cowl. Simple stranded colorwork with short floats for a smooth inner surface against the neck.

Foxglove Knee Socks

Advanced

Yarn: Fingering weight · Needles: 2.75mm · Yardage: 500yd · Colors: 4

Tall knee-high socks with foxglove flower motifs climbing the leg. Calf shaping is incorporated into the colorwork chart for a tailored fit.

Compass Point Toque

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 140yd · Colors: 4

A classic toque with compass rose motifs at the four cardinal points and small star fillers between. Crown decreases align with the compass design.

Tapestry Tote Bag

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 600yd · Colors: 5

A sturdy stranded colorwork tote with floral tapestry motifs. The dense stranded fabric creates a firm, structured bag that holds its shape without lining.

Midnight Garden Fingerless Mitts

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 3.75mm · Yardage: 140yd · Colors: 4

Dark floral motifs on black — roses and leaves emerging from shadow. The long fingerless format provides ample canvas for the repeating garden pattern.

Seed Packet Socks

Intermediate

Yarn: Fingering weight · Needles: 2.75mm · Yardage: 380yd · Colors: 4

Different flower motifs bloom on each sock, inspired by vintage seed packet illustrations. Stranded colorwork on the leg with a plain sole for comfort.

Timber Frame Ear Warmer

Beginner

Yarn: Worsted weight · Needles: 5mm · Yardage: 70yd · Colors: 2

A wide ear warmer with timber-frame cross motifs in two colors. Quick to knit on larger needles with a buttoned closure at the back.

Beekeeper's Hood

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 300yd · Colors: 4

A hooded cowl with honeycomb and bee motifs in golden yellows on cream. The hood portion is shaped with short rows while maintaining the colorwork pattern.

Autumn Acorn Hat

Beginner

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 130yd · Colors: 3

Tiny acorn motifs scattered across a warm brown hat with oak leaf borders at the brim. A charming seasonal accessory with simple two-color stranded bands.

Cosmic Dust Shawlette

Intermediate

Yarn: Fingering weight · Needles: 3.25mm · Yardage: 550yd · Colors: 4

A crescent shawlette with scattered star motifs on a deep space background. Stranded sections alternate with plain garter ridges for a lightweight drape.

Woodland Trail Gaiter

Beginner

Yarn: Worsted weight · Needles: 5mm ·
Yardage: 200yd · Colors: 3

A simple neck gaiter with tree silhouette motifs around the middle band. Drawstring top with a toggle for an adjustable fit over nose and mouth.

Pocket Watch Socks

Advanced

Yarn: Fingering weight · Needles: 2.75mm ·
Yardage: 400yd · Colors: 3

Clock face and gear motifs in steampunk-inspired colorwork down the sock leg. The intricate mechanical details challenge your chart-reading and tension skills.

Iceberg Mittens

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 3.75mm · Yardage: 150yd · Colors: 3

Geometric iceberg shapes float on an ocean-blue background with a subtle below-waterline shadow effect. Lined with a plain inner mitten for extra warmth.

Rosehip Tea Cozy

Beginner

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 180yd · Colors: 4

A charming tea cozy with rosehip berry motifs in red and orange on green branches. Worked flat in two panels with stranded colorwork and seamed at the sides.

Alpine Flower Bonnet

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 160yd · Colors: 4

A pixie-style bonnet with edelweiss and gentian motifs in alpine colors. I-cord ties and a pointed crown create a folk-art silhouette.

Fishbone Socks

Intermediate

Yarn: Fingering weight · Needles: 2.75mm ·
Yardage: 360yd · Colors: 2

Bold fishbone skeleton motifs run down the front of each sock in graphic black and white. The simple two-color palette makes the striking design accessible.

Mountain Pass Balaclava

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 250yd · Colors: 3

A full-coverage balaclava with mountain peak motifs around the face opening. Stranded colorwork throughout creates a windproof double-layer fabric.

Folklore Bird Drawstring Bag

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 300yd · Colors: 4

Stylized folk-art birds perch among branches on a round drawstring project bag. The stranded fabric makes a sturdy bag that protects its contents.

Solar Eclipse Cowl

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 380yd · Colors: 4

A circular cowl with a dramatic solar eclipse motif — dark moon crossing a radiant sun with corona rays. High contrast colors maximize the celestial drama.

Nutcracker Stocking

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 250yd · Colors: 5

A holiday stocking with nutcracker soldier motifs, toy drums, and snowflake borders. Traditional top-down construction with a turned heel and pointed toe.

Raindrop Slouch Hat

Beginner

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 140yd · Colors: 2

Scattered raindrop motifs on a slouchy hat in two calming blues. The small, well-spaced motifs produce short floats and an even, unstretched fabric.

Stag & Holly Table Runner

Advanced

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 700yd · Colors: 4

A long table runner with stag head motifs and holly leaf borders in traditional holiday colors. Flat stranded knitting with a purl-side facing creates a reversible fabric.

Coral Reef Clutch

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 200yd · Colors: 5

An envelope clutch with coral branch and seahorse motifs in tropical colors. Lined with fabric and closed with a vintage button for a polished finish.

Constellation Socks

Intermediate

Yarn: Fingering weight · Needles: 2.75mm · Yardage: 370yd · Colors: 3

Different constellations mapped on each sock against a midnight blue ground. Star points are worked in stranded colorwork with connecting lines in duplicate stitch.

Harvest Moon Headband

Beginner

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 75yd · Colors: 3

A wide headband with a full harvest moon rising over wheat sheaf motifs. Quick colorwork project with a twisted join at the back for comfort.

Ember Glow Convertible Mitts

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 3.75mm · Yardage: 180yd · Colors: 4

Convertible flip-top mittens with glowing ember motifs in oranges and reds. The flip-top reveals stranded fingerless gloves underneath for dexterity when needed.

Wanderlust Passport Cozy

Beginner

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 50yd · Colors: 3

A tiny stranded colorwork cover for a passport with globe and compass motifs. An excellent scrap-yarn project to practice colorwork on a miniature scale.

Pine Cone Boot Toppers

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 160yd · Colors: 3

Short boot cuffs with pine cone and needle motifs in forest colors. Worn folded over boot tops for a pop of handmade colorwork with any outfit.

Modern Geometric

Contemporary colorwork designs that push the boundaries with bold graphic shapes, minimalist palettes, and modern aesthetics — where traditional technique meets current design sensibility.

Binary Code Pullover

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1350yd · Colors: 2

Vertical columns of binary-inspired blocks and dashes in stark black and white. The digital aesthetic translates naturally into the pixel grid of knitted stitches.

Brutalist Blocks Cardigan

Intermediate

Yarn: Worsted weight · Needles: 5mm · Yardage: 1400yd · Colors: 3

Raw concrete-inspired color blocks in grays with single accent-color rectangles. Oversized fit and minimal finishing echo the architectural brutalist movement.

Gradient Pixel Fade Pullover

Advanced

Yarn: Fingering weight · Needles: 3.25mm · Yardage: 1700yd · Colors: 8

A pixel-by-pixel color gradient transitions from dark to light across the sweater body. Each row uses only two colors, but the palette shifts gradually through eight shades.

Tessellation Tee

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1100yd · Colors: 3

Interlocking geometric animal shapes tile seamlessly in an Escher-style tessellation. Short sleeves make this a warm-weather colorwork option with graphic impact.

Neon Grid Pullover

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1350yd · Colors: 3

A minimalist grid of thin neon lines on a black ground, intersecting at irregular intervals. The spare design creates maximum impact with minimal colorwork complexity.

Cuboid Stack Vest

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 800yd · Colors: 4

Three-dimensional cube illusions stacked in columns using three tones of one color plus white. The isometric perspective effect comes from strategic color placement.

Frequency Wave Pullover

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1400yd · Colors: 3

Sound-wave frequency patterns undulate across the body in a modern audio-visual aesthetic. Varying wave heights create rhythm and movement in the stranded design.

QR Code Tote

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 500yd · Colors: 2

A tote bag with a decorative QR-code-style grid pattern on each side. The random-looking arrangement of filled and empty squares creates an unmistakably digital aesthetic.

Memphis Style Pullover

Advanced

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1500yd · Colors: 6

Squiggles, dots, triangles, and confetti in bright primary colors on a white ground. The playful 1980s Memphis design movement rendered in stranded colorwork.

Asymmetric Slash Pullover

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1350yd · Colors: 3

A single bold diagonal color slash cuts across the sweater from shoulder to hip. Combines intarsia for the main division with stranded borders at the edges.

Sierpinski Triangle Shawl

Advanced

Yarn: Fingering weight · Needles: 3.25mm · Yardage: 800yd · Colors: 2

The fractal Sierpinski triangle pattern builds through progressive chart sections in a triangular shawl. Mathematical precision meets meditative knitting in this geometric marvel.

Minimalist Dot Grid Sweater

Beginner

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1250yd · Colors: 2

Evenly spaced single-stitch dots in a perfect grid across a contrasting ground. The simplest possible stranded motif executed with meticulous regularity for a refined look.

Op Art Ripple Pullover

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1400yd · Colors: 2

Concentric oval distortions in black and white create a pulsating optical illusion. High-contrast two-color work demands very even tension for the full visual effect.

Bauhaus Stripe Cardigan

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1400yd · Colors: 5

Horizontal color blocks of varying widths in a primary palette with black dividers. Each block is a clean stripe with color changes at row boundaries for simplicity.

Glitch Art Pullover

Advanced

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1450yd · Colors: 5

Deliberately disrupted pattern bands simulate digital image glitches with displaced pixels and color artifacts. Controlled chaos that requires precise chart following.

Hex Grid Cowl

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 350yd · Colors: 3

Tessellating hexagons in three colors form a honeycomb grid around a deep cowl. The geometric precision of the hex shapes comes from careful stitch-count planning.

Topography Lines Pullover

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1350yd · Colors: 3

Concentric topographic contour lines flow across the sweater in a modern cartographic style. The organic-yet-geometric lines create a meditative, map-like surface.

Voxel Landscape Vest

Advanced

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 900yd · Colors: 5

An isometric voxel landscape with blocky trees, hills, and a river in video-game-inspired style. The three-dimensional pixel art translates into a charming stranded design.

Deconstructed Plaid Pullover

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1400yd · Colors: 4

A plaid pattern that fragments and dissolves at the edges into scattered pixels. Combines structured stranded sections with isolated float-free motif elements.

Voronoi Cell Blanket

Advanced

Yarn: Worsted weight · Needles: 5mm · Yardage: 2200yd · Colors: 4

Organic Voronoi cell divisions in contrasting colors create a natural-yet-mathematical pattern. The irregular cell shapes are charted row by row using intarsia techniques.

Scanline Fade Socks

Intermediate

Yarn: Fingering weight · Needles: 2.75mm · Yardage: 380yd · Colors: 3

Horizontal scanlines dissolve from dense color at the cuff to scattered pixels at the toe. A dithering effect achieved through progressively sparser colorwork rows.

Tangram Puzzle Pullover

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 1400yd · Colors: 5

Large tangram shapes arranged across the sweater front in bold primary colors. The angular pieces combine intarsia for large areas with stranded edges for detail.

Data Mosaic Beanie

Beginner

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage: 120yd · Colors: 3

Random-looking but carefully charted color blocks in a data-visualization aesthetic. The small scale makes this a quick project with a distinctly modern feel.

Penrose Tiling Throw

Advanced

Yarn: Worsted weight · Needles: 5mm · Yardage: 2400yd · Colors: 3

Aperiodic Penrose kite-and-dart tiling translated into a knitted blanket. The non-repeating pattern challenges both chart reading and mathematical patience.

Gradient Chevron Crop Top

Intermediate

Yarn: DK weight · Needles: 4mm · Yardage:
700yd · Colors: 5

Sharp chevron bands in a five-color gradient
from warm to cool across a cropped silhouette.
The compact size makes this a satisfying
weekend colorwork project.

Next Step

Continue exploring The Ultimate Knitting Library — more volumes await with hundreds of additional patterns.